F Lent 5 Grammar notes

More on negative phrases

- **We have already seen that French uses two words which go around the conjugated verb** that you wish to make negative. The first word is always "ne" and the second word is usually one of the following:

  - **NE + pas[1]/plus[2]/jamais[3]/rien[4]/personne[5]/nulle part[6]/que[7]**
    not[1]/no longer[2]/never[3]/nothing[4]/nobody[5]/nowhere[6]/only[7]

- We also saw in Chapter 7 that in the perfect tense, **three of the above particles came after the past participle** rather than the conjugated verb:

  - *Elle n'a vu personne. Il n'est allé nulle part. On n'a vu que Pierre.*

- Here are **two other negative expressions** that, like *ne…que,* are placed where they are needed, rather than in a set place:

  - *ne + aucun(e)* = *not a single*
  - *ne + ni…ni* = *neither…nor*

- In the present tense, the position of the second particle is often obvious, but in the perfect tense, **the positioning depends on the meaning** of the sentence.

  - *Je n'ai aucun ami. Nous n'avons vu que des girafes.*
  - *Nous n'avons vu des girafes que dans le parc.*
  - *Nous n'avons vu des girafes dans le parc qu'une seule fois.*
  - *Nous n'avons vu ni girafes ni éléphants.*

- **Remember**:
  - *AUCUN* – has to agree with what it negates and can only be used in front of nouns that could be counted, ie not *"~~aucun argent~~"* or *"~~aucun lait~~"*, but *"aucun livre"* and *"aucune table"*.

- "**TO BE OR NOT TO BE**". This is an example of an infinitive and a negative infinitive. To form a negative infinitive in French the two negative particles go TOGETHER BEFORE it: **être ou NE PAS être**. **NULLE PART** and **PERSONNE** are the exceptions, and these go around the infinitive.

  - *Je préfère NE RIEN dire. Il a décidé de NE RIEN acheter.*
    Elle a promis de N'aller NULLE PART.
    Il a promis de NE frapper PERSONNE

Direct object pronouns: *I saw HIM, we ate IT*

- The person who "does the action of the verb" is called the subject and you have already learned the subject pronouns in French:
    - *je, tu, il/elle, nous, vous, ils/elles*.
- There is often an "object" of a verb, too. It doesn't "do" the verb, it "has the action of the verb done to it". Object pronouns are the shorthand way of refering to these, and there is a group of 6, like there are 6 subject pronouns.
    - *me*[1], *te*[2], *le/la*[3], *nous*[4], *vous*[5], *les*[6]
- Unlike in English, in French, **Direct Object Pronouns are placed BEFORE THE CONJUGATED VERB.** (Except in positive commands to be studied later.)
    - *Je t'aime. Nous les regardons, Elles m'ont vu*.
- If there is an infinitive after the conjugated verb, **the OBJECT PRONOUN will go BEFORE THE INFINITIVE**.
    - *Je veux te voir. Il a décidé de l'écouter. Nous allons le faire*.
- The list of OBJECT PRONOUNS to learn this week are called **DIRECT OBJECT PRONOUNS.** These are the object pronouns that are used with verbs that do not use a preposition:
    - *faire qc/manger qc/ voir qn/ écouter qn/attendre qn.*

Another case where avoir past participles agree

- We saw in Lent chapter 3 that after **a descriptive "que" clause**, that the past participle of an "avoir verb" would agree: *les films que j'ai vus.*
- Technically, this is called a **PDO** (preceding direct object). It means that the direct object of the verb "precedes" (comes before) avoir, and this triggers an agreement of the past participle. Below follows a case of PDO that is much easier to spot than the one above.
- A DIRECT OBJECT PRONOUN comes before AVOIR, the participle will agree:
    - *je les ai vuS. Nous les avons mangéS. Elle l'a prisE* (sthg fem.)
      nous vous avons vuS (2 people) *Elle les a frappéS*